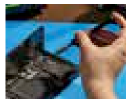
Seal of Approval
Activision Blizzard shareholders approve of the $68.7 billion deal from Microsoft. **https://dgit.in/may22-35**



Apple allows DIY!
Apple opens up self service to its customers in the US with genuine Apple part and tools available. **https://dgit.in/may22-36**

Staying cool

Agent001 is called in to help cool things down

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The other day one of my friends called about something rather peculiar, the CPU cooler installed in the desktop computer was making a sloshing noise followed by a steady gurgling. It goes without saying that my friend was aghast, and with good reason, since hearing anything resembling the sound of water near expensive electronic components is bound to send one's heartrate soaring. For me, it sounded as if the coolant within the CPU cooler had run low. So I headed to their place to check out their PC.

Closed loop CPU coolers like the one installed in my friend's PC aren't meant to be serviced. They're closed for a reason. These CPU coolers are built in a neutral environment to ensure that no external particulate matter or organic matter enters the system. Because if they do, then the warm and wet environment makes for a great ecosystem for scummy algae to grow with reckless abandon. This is why CPU cooler manufacturers throw in a couple of different germicidal and herbicidal additives in the coolant mix that's used in most coolers.

Occasionally, due to normal wear and tear or improper handling, minor stress points come to be along the body. These points, over time, end up worsening and they give way resulting in micro-cracks. Since the coolant within these CPU coolers is usually a mix of Propylene Glycol and Water. Neither fluid showcases high volatility, so when such micro-cracks appear, the coolant mix starts evaporating very slowly. Over a couple of months, you'll notice that a good amount of the coolant has evaporated and that's when you start hearing the sloshing sounds. And if organic matter makes its way into the coolant then you'll get an algae build up which will really mess things up.

So the question is ... can you refill an AIO? Technically, you can refill an AIO. Propylene glycol can be sourced easily and distilled water is also widely available for purchase. Making a 1:9 or 1:10 mix and refilling an AIO isn't difficult. Some AIOs even come with a fill port on the radiator which can be used to top it up. However, if you go down this road, then you will have to make it part of your regular maintenance schedule for your PC. This is because there's no telling how things are going to turn out. Also, the micro-crack needs to be identified and patched up. It could be a simple job of applying a layer of an industrial grade sealant over the micro-crack or you might need to replace one of the fittings. Both solutions are doable but identifying the location of the micro-crack is an entirely different ball game. You could try emptying out the fluid from the cooler and submerging it in water so that air bubbles start escaping from the micro-cracks. However, this would only happen with larger cracks. Micro-cracks in their early